RURAL LANDSCAPES TURNING VIBRANT HUBS

Haryana inspires a new era of innovation



Encouraging youth-led initiatives, digital governance and participatory decision-making, the Panchayati Raj reforms in the state are transforming rural landscapes into vibrant hubs of innovation and community-driven progress

In a significant move to strengthen grassroots democracy and accelerate rural development, the Haryana Government has introduced a series of far-reaching reforms empowering Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) and promoting transparency, inclusivity, and digital transformation in villages.

Under the new framework, sarpanches can now undertake development works worth up to ₹21 lakh without e-tendering, a measure designed to streamline local projects and reduce administrative delays.

In a symbolic step to elevate the role of village heads, the government has accorded protocol status to sarpanches, ensuring that they get designated seating alongside senior officials such as the DSP, at official events.

With a view to strengthening financial autonomy, 2% of the electricity consumption charges and a share in stamp duty is now directly credited to panchayat accounts. Additionally, the government has expanded reservations for Backward Classes, granting 8% to BC-A and 5% to BC-B categories in PRI bodies, while also reaffirming 50% representation for women—a landmark decision for gender inclusion in rural governance.



Between October 2014 and 27 October 2025, the government sanctioned ₹26,333.59 crore for various rural development projects across the state. To date, 5,750 'Gaurav Patta' projects have been completed, celebrating model villages that exemplify progress and good governance.

GRAM DARSHAN PORTAL

The 'Gram Darshan Portal', a participatory governance platform, continues to be a success story. Up to July 30, 2025, it had received over 32,296 public demands, out of which 22,921 had been approved by representatives, and 9,209 projects were under execution.. Out of these, 576 have been completed. In order to encourage youth participation, the 'Gravit–Gramin Vikas Ke Liye Tarun' Scheme motivates rural youth to become active volunteers for local development. The government is establishing e-libraries in villages to promote education and digital literacy. The first such facility, the Rs 20-lakh Sardar Patel Library in Karnal district, has been inaugurated. Approval has been granted for 994 e-libraries, with 954 buildings repaired and equipped with gym and digital facilities.

The state has also launched 'Gram Sachivalaya' initiative, establishing 2,531 village secretariats where officials from different departments operate under one roof to deliver public services efficiently. In a landmark decision aimed at benefiting farmers, compensation for the land used for installing high-tension power lines